

Make Winning an Attitude: Embody Your Positivity, Featuring Timothy Alexander

Timothy Alexander, Director of UAB Football Character Excellence Program & Life Coach

As Pat said, “With attitude, you can determine your own performance. But more than that, you can help determine the performance of others. A single individual with a strong, positive attitude can lift those around her. She can change the course of events. Sometimes a positive person can walk into a room and immediately the air feels different. It’s as though her presence literally converts ions from negative to positive.”

When you encounter doubt in yourself or negativity from others, that’s when choosing to have a positive attitude sustains your performance.

Here are three ways to embody your positivity when life throws you a curveball.

Number one: resist negativity with resiliency. Resiliency is the capacity to respond to adversity quickly. Don’t avoid your problems by playing hide and seek with them. Problems are challenges that give you the opportunity to renew your mind and be transformed. Embrace your problems and make the most of them.

Number two: do your doubt. The only way to handle doubt in a positive way is to simply do what your doubt is keeping you from doing. With so much going on in the world, information overload is just a click away and it can be easy to feel overwhelmed. Lean into your doubts because you’ll never know what’s possible until you try. If you quit, you’ll never win.

Number three: be accountable in a positive way. A winning attitude has to face reality and take responsibility. Good leaders make space for acknowledging challenges. Once you see the challenge, ask yourself, “What do I do with this challenge?” Ask, “What needs to change?” Then, go be that change and embody your positivity for others.

When someone under your leadership is struggling, remind them why they started this journey in the first place. Sometimes, it means being direct about why you’re applying pressure: because you know they can do better and them doing better is beneficial for both of you.

As Pat said, “Attitude is a choice. What you think you can do, whether positive or negative, confident or scared, will most likely happen. When you doubt, you create a negative. It will affect your performance and probably drag others down, too.”

Are you willing to be the difference for your team? Choose to operate in gratitude every day. Be thankful for your challenges. When you make winning an attitude, adversity helps you find out who you’re truly meant to be.

